

Martin Heidegger, *Basic Concepts of Aristotelian Philosophy*

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§18. Πάθος.

Its General Meanings and Its Role in Human Being-There

(*Metaphysics* Δ21, *De Anima* Α1)

Book pp. 129–139 · PDF pp. 144–154

Orienting Thesis of §18

§18 is the systematic centerpiece of Chapter 3 of the First Part. Where §17 unfolded *ἕξις* (*hexis*, “having,” “composure”) as a fundamental concept of being, §18 turns to *πάθος* (*pathos*, “being-taken,” “being-affected”) and shows that the two are co-originary structures of being-there (*Da-sein*). Heidegger’s overarching claim: *πάθος* (*pathos*) is not a “psychic experience,” not an “affect” lodged inside consciousness, and not a “bodily symptom” attached to a soul. It is a *determination of the being of living things*—specifically, a way in which human being-there is *taken* by the world as the wherein of its own being. Read against Aristotle’s *Metaphysics* Δ21 and *De Anima* Α1, *πάθος* (*pathos*) discloses that the human being is to be understood as a *bodily being-in-the-world* (*σῶμα*, *sōma*, “body” / corporeality)—and this discovery overturns the entire Cartesian distinction between *res cogitans* (thinking thing) and *res extensa* (extended thing) which, Heidegger insists, is *not* found in Aristotle.

§18a. Ἑξις (*hexis*) as Clue to the Conception of the Being-Structure of *πάθος* (*pathos*)

pp. 129–131

The Methodological Move

Heidegger transitions from §17 by carrying forward two results: (1) *ἕξις* (*hexis*, “composure,” “being-composed-as-to”) is *not* completeness in the sense of routine; and (2) *ἕξις* (*hexis*) is intrinsically related to its negation—to being-brought-out-of-composure, which is precisely *πάθος* (*pathos*). Because *ἕξις* (*hexis*) is the more accessible structure (we can read it through *ἀρετή* [*aretē*, “virtue,” “excellence”] and the analyses of *Nicomachean Ethics* B), it serves as a hermeneutic clue to the more elusive being-structure of *πάθος* (*pathos*). The path is deliberately roundabout: we approach *πάθος* (*pathos*) only after *ἕξις* (*hexis*) has shown us what the *how* of being-composed looks like.

What *πάθη* (*pathē*) Are NOT

Heidegger executes a sharp negative determination—three rejections that frame the entire section:

1. Not “spiritual states” (*geistige Zustände*): *πάθη* (*pathē*) are not interior episodes of a soul thought of as an inward chamber.

2. Not “bodily symptoms”: they are not somatic accompaniments to mental events.
3. Not the dualistic compound of the two: the very framing—psychic state plus bodily symptom—already presupposes a Cartesian split that Aristotle does not make.

Instead, *πάθη* (*pathē*) “characterize the entire human being in its *disposition in the world*” (p. 129). The German *Befindlichkeit*—Heidegger’s later term in *Being and Time* §29—is already in view here: *πάθη* (*pathē*) are how the whole being-there finds itself in its world.

The *De Anima* Reframing

Heidegger reads *De Anima* (Περὶ ψυχῆς, *Peri psychēs*, “On the Soul”) not as a psychology but as ontology:

“The entire human being is the primary object dealt with in the Aristotelian psychology of *De Anima*, Book 1. The entire human being must be understood with regard to its being as ζῶν (*zōē*, ‘life’), as being-in-a-world—thus grasped as a genuine topic not of psychology but of the *discussion of the being of this being*.” (p. 129)

Φόβος (*phobos*, “fear”) as Test Case

Heidegger introduces fear (*φόβος*, *phobos*) here as the leading example because Aristotle’s analysis of fear is so broad that Aristotle “becomes attentive to the fact that there is fear even if nothing is there that would be the direct inducement of a fear—*fear in the face of the nothing*” (p. 129). This is a striking proto-formulation of the analytic that will return as *Angst* (anxiety) in *Being and Time* §40. From this, Heidegger draws a programmatic conclusion: “the way the Greeks view being as genuinely in the *present*, being as cared for in the mode of *presentness*, becomes intelligible” (p. 129)—i.e., the Greek ontology of presence (*Anwesenheit*) is itself rooted in the structure of disposed being-in-the-world which *πάθος* (*pathos*) discloses.

The ἀρετή (*aretē*) Bridge

Before he leaves §18a, Heidegger reactivates the *Nicomachean Ethics* B 6 definition: ἀρετή (*aretē*) is a ἕξις προαιρετική (*hexis proairetikē*, “a composure-of-resolve”), a μεσότης (*mesotēs*, “mean”) “as the φρόνιμος (*phronimos*, ‘the prudent one’) would resolve it.” The point: ἕξις (*hexis*) in relation to the *πάθη* (*pathē*) is “to be our clue to the more precise conception of the being-structure of the *πάθη* themselves” (p. 131). What ἀρετή (*aretē*) does to *πάθη* (*pathē*)—namely, hold them in the moment (*καιρός*, *kairos*, “the right moment”)—already shows that *πάθη* (*pathē*) are precisely *that which is held* in being-composed.

§18b. The Four General Meanings of *πάθος* (*pathos*)

(*Metaphysics* 21, 1022b 15–21) · pp. 131–132

Heidegger walks through Aristotle’s four senses of *πάθος* (*pathos*) in *Metaphysics* Δ Chapter 21, in the order they appear, and shows that they form a *progressive narrowing* from the broadest ontological sense to the specifically harmful.

1. πάθος as ποιότης καθ' ἣν ἀλλοιοῦσθαι ἐνδέχεται

(*poiotes kath' hēn alloiousthai endechetai*, “a being-constituted regarding which alteration is possible”)

“πάθος λέγεται ἓνα μὲν τρόπον ποιότης καθεῖν ἀλλοιοῦσθαι ἐνδέχεται” (Met. Δ21, 1022b 15)

Translation: “πάθος is said in one way as a being-constituted, regarding which something underlies alteration.” Examples: white–black, sweet–bitter, heavy–light. The crucial phrase is *not just* “any property” but a property “characterized in itself such that it offers the possibility of what was thus constituted being reversed.” This is the *broadest* sense: πάθος (*pathos*) here means *alterability as such*—being-such-that-one-can-become-otherwise.

Heidegger’s key gloss: “Something can *happen* to such a being.” The German *geschehen* (“to happen”) here is the precise rendering of πάσχειν (*paschein*, “to undergo”). And—decisively—“to happen” does not mean *passive*; it means *something occurs for me* (*es widerfährt mir*). The first sense of πάθος (*pathos*) is therefore: possibility of ἀλλοιώσις (*alloiōsis*, “becoming–otherwise”); “πάθος is a determination of beings with the character of alterability” (p. 131).

2. πάθος as ἐνέργειαι καὶ ἀλλοιώσεις ἤδη

(*energeiai kai alloiōseis ēdē*, “actualizations and already-occurring alterations”)

“ἓνα δὲ αἱ τούτων ἐνέργειαι καὶ ἀλλοιώσεις ἤδη” (Met. Δ21, 1022b 18)

Translation: “another sense [of πάθος]: the actualization and already-occurring alterations of those (constitutions).” The second sense narrows from *possibility* to *actuality*: πάθος (*pathos*) is now the “being–there of such a shifting occurring–to–one.” Where (1) gave us alterability–as–possibility, (2) gives us the *event* of alteration as ἐνέργεια (*energeia*, “actuality,” “being–at–work”). Beings of this kind are characterized by carrying within themselves the possibility of something occurring to them—perhaps in relation to a color (Heidegger’s example tracking Aristotle).

3. πάθος as βλαβεραὶ ἀλλοιώσεις καὶ κινήσεις, καὶ μάλιστα αἱ λυπηραὶ βλάβαι

(*blaberaí alloiōseis kai kinēseis, kai malista hai lypērai blabai*, “harmful alterations and motions, and especially harmful pains”)

“ἔτι ἐπὶ τούτων μᾶλλον ἢ βλαβεραὶ ἀλλοιώσεις καὶ κινήσεις, καὶ μάλιστα αἱ λυπηραὶ βλάβαι” (Met. Δ21, 1022b 19)

Translation: still further: harmful alterations and motions, and most of all painful damages. The third sense narrows again—now to *the unpleasant* (τὸ βλαβερόν, *to blaberon*, “the harmful”): “πάθος as the occurring–to–one that has the character of the unpleasant.” Aristotle restricts the meaning further: harmfulness is referred most of all to λύπη (*lypē*, “pain”). Heidegger’s translation: “my attunement to this occurring affects me”—a *becoming–otherwise in the sense of becoming–depressed*. The word “attunement” (*Gestimmtheit*) is again the proto–*Stimmung* of *Being and Time*.

4. πάθος as τὰ μεγέθη τῶν συμφορῶν καὶ λυπηρῶν

(*ta megethē tōn sumphorōn kai lypērōn*, “the magnitudes of misfortunes and pains”)

“ἔτι τὰ μεγέθη τῶν συμφορῶν καὶ λυπηρῶν πάθη λέγεται” (*Met.* Δ21, 1022b 20)

Translation: “further, the magnitudes of misfortunes and griefs are called *πάθη*.” The narrowest sense: *πάθος* (*pathos*) as the size, the *measure* of what occurs harmfully. Heidegger’s idiomatic German equivalent: “*das ist ein Schlag für mich*”—“that is a blow to me.” Here *πάθος* (*pathos*) names the *intensity* of the affective event.

The Synthesis Heidegger Draws

“From these four meanings, the *genuine relatedness* of *πάθος* (*pathos*) becomes visible: it is related to the *being of living things*.” (p. 132)

The four senses converge on a single ontological discovery:

- ^c*πάθος* (*pathos*) is the structure of occurring-to-oneself-again-and-again (*Sichereignen*).
- ^cThis occurring has in itself the character of the harmful—connected to *φθορά* (*phthora*, “destruction”).
- ^cBut it *also* has the character of *σωτηρία* (*sōtēria*, “preservation,” “saving”): “Something occurs to me by which I do not lose composure but, on the contrary, gain it more genuinely” (p. 132).
- ^cAristotle thus recognizes *πάθος* (*pathos*) as comprising *μεταβολή* (*metabolē*, “change”), *κίνησις* (*kinēsis*, “motion”), and *ἀλλοίωσις* (*alloiōsis*, “alteration”).

Excursus: What “the Single Ontological Discovery” Names

The bullets above list four *features* of the convergence; they do not yet state the *one thing* that the four senses converge *on*. The convergence-point can be named directly:

The four senses of *πάθος* (*pathos*) converge on the discovery that *to be a living being just is to be ontologically structured as occurrable-to*: the being of *ζωή* (*zōē*, “life”) is itself the structure of *being-able-to-have-something-happen-to-one*, *μεταβλητόν* (*metablēton*, “the changeable”).

Πάθος (*pathos*) is *not* one thing among others that living beings happen to undergo; *πάθος* *names what it is to be alive*. Read top-to-bottom, the four Δ21 senses are not a list of distinct meanings but four progressively-narrowing optics on a *single* ontological structure:

1. Sense (1) — Alterability isolates the *bare ontological fact*: this kind of being has the possibility of becoming-otherwise built into its constitution. This establishes *πάθος* (*pathos*) as a *structural-ontological* category, not an accidental episode.
2. Sense (2) — Actualization shows the same structure *in its being-at-work* (*ἐνέργεια*, *energeia*): the structure of (1) is not idle potency but is constantly being exercised in the life of the living.
3. Sense (3) — Harmful alteration reveals that the alterability of (1) is *vulnerability*: a living being is not just changeable but *exposed*.
4. Sense (4) — Magnitude of misfortune shows that the structure of (1)–(3) is felt-as-mattering: *πάθος* (*pathos*) *carries weight* in the being of the one who undergoes it.

Read together, the four senses describe a *single* being: a being whose mode of being is to be openable, alterable, vulnerable, and weight-bearing-of-its-own-occurrences — i.e., a *living being*. That convergent structure is what Heidegger means at p. 132:

“From these four meanings, the *genuine relatedness* of πάθος (*pathos*) becomes visible: it is related to the *being of living things*, which is characterized by a thus-finding-oneself-again-and-again.”

The phrase “*thus-finding-oneself-again-and-again*” (*Sichereignen*, “the occurring-to-oneself”) is the precise name of the discovery. Three claims are made at once:

- ◌Occurring — πάθος (*pathos*) is *event-structured*: not a state, not a property, but a happening.
- ◌To oneself — the event is not external. The very being to which it happens is constituted *as* the one to whom it can happen. There is no living being that *first* exists and *then* gets affected; to be alive is to be already constituted as affectable.
- ◌Again and again — this is not a one-time origin-event but the ongoing texture of life itself. Living *is* this repeating-structure of being-occurred-to. (This is why §17 linked ἕξις (*hexis*) to “the frequently of repetition”: the αἰεί (*aei*, “always”) of being-there is the πολλάκις (*pollakis*, “frequently”) of πάθος.)

Concrete real-world example: hearing your name called

Walk into a crowded room. Someone behind you says your name. Before you decide anything, you *turn*. That turn is not a choice; it is the structure of being-a-living-thing-in-a-world becoming visible in a single instant.

- ◌Sense 1 (*alterability*): You *are the kind of being* for whom the sound of your name is a possible alteration — your nervous system is constituted to be structurally re-arrangeable by a phoneme-pattern. This is not contingent; it is *what you are*.
- ◌Sense 2 (*actualization*): The alteration is now *actual* — the turning, the heart-rate change, the redirection of attention. The structure of (I) at work, ἐνέργεια (*energeia*).
- ◌Sense 3 (*the unpleasant / weighted in the broad sense*): Even before you know who is calling, your body has already registered a *concerned weighting* — is this a friend? a creditor? someone I owe an apology? The affection is already *toned*, already mattering.
- ◌Sense 4 (*magnitude*): The intensity of the turn is *proportioned to who you are*. If it is your boss whom you have been avoiding, “this is a blow to me.” If it is a friend, the same call has a different μέγεθος (*megethos*, “magnitude”). Πάθος (*pathos*) here measures *how much you are taken*.

What the four senses show *together*: there is no neutral pre-affective “you” who *then* gets affected. The you that turns *is constituted by* its capacity to be turned. To be alive is to be the kind of being whose name *can* call you — and whose constitution is therefore the constitution of being-occurable-to. Πάθος (*pathos*) is not what happens to a living being; πάθος (*pathos*) is the *being-structure* of a living being. The four senses are four ways of saying this one thing.

The Hegelian Footnote

Heidegger interjects what is one of the most-cited remarks of GA 18: “Hegel took the phenomenon of σώζειν (*sōzein*, ‘to save,’ ‘to preserve’) from Aristotle in the expression *Aufhebung* (sublation)” (p. 132). The triple sense of *Aufhebung*—to negate, to preserve, to elevate—is supposedly already operative in Aristotelian σωτηρία (*sōtēria*). [The Phase 2 commentary flags this as INTERP-high: it is contestable whether Aristotle’s σώζειν (*sōzein*) genuinely supports the Hegelian triadic structure or whether Heidegger is retrojecting.]

The Steretic Counterpart

Against the μεταβολή (*metabolē*) through which ἕξις (*hexis*) is *saved*, Heidegger sets a kind of πάσχειν (*paschein*) “that has the character of στερητικόν (*sterētikon*, ‘deprivative’)” — “something happens to me by which I lose the ἕξις (*hexis*)—for example, becoming-old” (p. 132). The full ontological signature of πάθος (*pathos*) is therefore *bivalent*: it both deprives (φθορά, *phthora*) and preserves/elevates (σωτηρία, *sōtēria*)—“a saving in the sense of safekeeping, of raising to a higher genuine being of ἐνέργεια (*energeia*)” (p. 132).

Excursus: The Bivalent Character of Πάθος (*pathos*) — Deprivation and Preservation

The bivalence claim turns on Aristotle’s pair φθορά (*phthora*, “destruction”) / σωτηρία (*sōtēria*, “preservation,” “saving-through”) at *De Anima* B 5, 417b 2 (Heidegger’s footnote 242). Heidegger reads this pair as expressing a single insight: *the same structure of being-affected can either tear down a (hexis) or build it up*. To be a living being is to be the kind of thing that *can be touched, struck, moved* — and *this very capacity to be touched* is precisely what allows the being either to lose what it has or to come more genuinely into what it is.

The Two Senses Formally

Πάθος as φθορά (*phthora*) — Something happens to me, and I *lose* a ἕξις (*hexis*). The example Heidegger gives — *becoming-old* — is the case where the very same exposure-to-the-world that kept me composed (a ἕξις of strength, of stamina, of memory, of bodily competence) is now the medium by which that ἕξις is dismantled. Στερητικόν (*sterētikon*, “deprivative”) is the technical word: the body’s openness to the world is here functioning *negatively*.

Πάθος as σωτηρία (*sōtēria*) — Something happens to me, and I do *not* lose composure; *on the contrary* (Heidegger’s emphasis at p. 132), I am *brought more genuinely into* what I am, lifted to a higher ἐνέργεια (*energeia*). The very same capacity-to-be-affected is here functioning *positively*: it is the medium by which the ἕξις (*hexis*) is sealed in, raised up, consolidated.

The point Heidegger is hammering on: it is the *one* structure — being-affectable, being-takable, μεταβολή (*metabolē*) — that does both. Πάθος (*pathos*) is not “the bad thing that happens to good ἕξις”; πάθος is the *ontological condition* of any living being whatsoever, and *what it does to the depends on the case*.

Why “Becoming-Old” Alone is Unclear

Aristotle’s becoming-old example is doing only half the work: it shows the φθορά-side. To see the bivalence one needs to *pair* it with a σωτηρία-case — and Aristotle himself supplies one in the same passage of *De Anima* B 5: the case of *learning*, where the soul “is acted upon” by what it learns, but rather than being destroyed by this affection it is *preserved and perfected* by it. This is the ἑτέρου γένους ἀλλοιώσεως (*heterou genous alloiōseōs*, “another kind of alteration”) that Aristotle explicitly distinguishes at *De an.* B 5, 417b 14 — the very passage Heidegger cites in note 244 of GA 18.

Concrete Real-World Example: The Cellist

Take a serious cellist who has cultivated, over decades, a ἕξις (*hexis*) of playing — composure-toward-the-instrument. Now consider two kinds of event that “happen to” her:

Case A — Πάθος as φθορά (*phthora*). She develops focal dystonia in her left hand. The hand is *taken-by-the-world*: tendons, nerves, and motor-cortex are *struck* in a way she did not author. *The same bodily openness that made her a cellist* — the fact that her hand *can* be affected, trained, shaped, moved by the music — is now the medium through which the ἔξις is *taken away*. She loses composure-toward-the-instrument. This is πάσχειν (*paschein*) in the στερητικόν mode: a μεταβολή by which she *loses the ἔξις*. Aristotle would call this exactly parallel to becoming-old.

Case B — Πάθος as σωτηρία (*sōtēria*). Years earlier, the same cellist sat in a lesson with a great teacher who, mid-phrase, *struck her* with a single observation: “*You are gripping the bow like an enemy.*” The remark *takes her*. She is brought-out-of-her-current-composure (this is genuinely a πάθος, a being-affected, not a self-initiated thought). She does *not* lose her ἔξις-of-playing; on the contrary, the having-been-struck is the *very means* by which the ἔξις is *sealed, deepened, raised to a higher* . She emerges from the encounter *more genuinely the cellist she already was*. This is σωτηρία in the precise Aristotelian sense: a μεταβολή through which the ἔξις is *saved* — preserved by being brought to a higher actuality.

The two cases are *the same structure, the same capacity-to-be-affected, the same openness to* . The dystonia-event and the lesson-event are both πάθη in the strict sense. They differ only in their *direction*: one tears down the ἔξις, the other builds it up. This is what Heidegger means at p. 132 when he says πάθος is “that which deprives one of a matter, and a preserving, a saving — preserving in the sense of safekeeping, of raising to a higher, genuine being of ἐνέργεια (*energeia*).”

Why Heidegger Then Invokes Hegel

The Hegelian footnote at p. 132 follows immediately from the bivalence: *Aufhebung* in Hegel has exactly this triadic structure — to *negate* (φθορά: the dystonia takes away her old playing), to *preserve* (σωτηρία: the lesson-comment does not dissolve her playing but holds it fast in a new form), and to *elevate* (raising to a higher ἐνέργεια: she now plays with a depth she did not have before). Hegel’s claim, on Heidegger’s reading, is that the German *Aufhebung* simply names what σώζειν (*sōzein*) had already named in Aristotle.

Why the Bivalence Matters Ontologically

The bivalence is *not* a moral observation (“life has ups and downs”); it is a structural ontological point. Without it, πάθος would be merely the privative complement to ἔξις — pure loss. *With* it, πάθος is shown to be the structural medium through which the human being either becomes-itself or unbecomes-itself. Being-takable-by-the-world is the very condition for being-able-to-grow into one’s own being. This is why §18 will close with the recognition that the πάθη force us to take the human being *in its fullness* — because everything that matters about who I am is decided in *how I am taken* by what happens.

§18c. Πάθος (*pathos*) as the Being-Taken of Human Being-There in Its Full Bodily Being-in-the-World

This is the longest and ontologically most ambitious subsection. Heidegger pushes beyond Aristotle's textual articulation to argue that πάθος (*pathos*) names the *fundamental phenomenon* of human bodily being-in-the-world.

The Core Definition

“Πάθος (*pathos*), in relation to the ζωή πρακτική μετὰ λόγου (*zōē praktikē meta logou*, ‘practical life with speech/reason’), is thus a *being-taken* of being-there. Being-there is taken with that which is there in the world—from without, but from without *in the sense of the world as the wherein of my being*.” (p. 133)

The phrase “from without” (*von außen*) is not spatial exteriority of object-to-subject. The “without” is precisely the world *as already mine*—the world *as the wherein of my being*. So πάθος (*pathos*) is being-taken-by-the-world-from-the-world-as-mine. There is no Cartesian gap to be bridged because the bridge is the original phenomenon.

Refusing the “Spiritual”

“This being-taken of being-there as being-in-its-world does not involve anything like what we could designate as the ‘spiritual,’ which invites the conception of πάθος (*pathos*) as affect. Instead, it is always a being-taken of beings as living things as such.” (p. 133)

The polemic targets the entire post-Cartesian inheritance: faculty psychology, the affect-tradition (Spinoza, Hume), and even Brentano's intentional-content model. None of these fits Aristotle.

The Anti-Locutionary Argument

Heidegger advances a remarkable linguistic-phenomenological observation:

“I cannot say that the soul hopes, has fears, has pity; instead, I can only say that the human being hopes, is brave.” (p. 133)

He cites *De Anima* A 4, 408b 11: “τὸ δὴ λέγειν ὀργίζεσθαι τὴν ψυχὴν ὁμοιον καὶ εἰ τις λέγοι τὴν ψυχὴν ὑφαίνειν ἢ οἰκοδομεῖν” —“To say that the soul gets angry is the same as saying that the soul builds a house.” It would be better to say not that the soul has pity, learns, or believes something, but that *the human being does so* (*tē psychē*, “with the soul,” dative of instrument or of respect). Soul (ψυχή, *psychē*) is here grasped as οὐσία (*ousia*, “substance,” “being”)—i.e., as that-by-which-the-living-thing-is, *not* as a self-standing inner subject.

What This Means for the πάθη (*pathē*)

“The πάθη (*pathē*) are not ‘psychic experiences,’ are not ‘in consciousness,’ but are a being-taken of human beings *in their full being-in-the-world*. That is expressed by the fact that the whole, the full occurrence-context, which is found in this happening, in being-taken, belongs to the πάθη. The so-called ‘bodily states’ of anxiety, joy, and so forth, are not symptoms, but also belong to the characteristic being of beings, of human beings.” (p. 133)

The “occurrence-context” (*Vorkommniszusammenhang*) is the *whole worldly situation* in which the human is taken—so anxiety is not “an inner state with bodily accompaniment” but is *the whole disposed being-in-the-world*, body and world inseparably included.

De Anima A 1 — the Aporia (403a 3 sqq.)

Heidegger now reads Aristotle’s opening aporia of *De Anima* A 1 directly:

“ἀπορίαν δὲ ἔχει καὶ τὰ πάθη τῆς ψυχῆς, πότερόν ἐστι πάντα κοινὰ καὶ τοῦ ἔχοντος ἢ ἐστὶ τι καὶ τῆς ψυχῆς ἴδιον αὐτῆς” (*De an.* A 1, 403a 3)

Translation: “There is also an aporia regarding the πάθη (*pathē*) of the soul: whether they are all common to that-which-has [the soul, i.e., the human being] or whether some are proper to the soul itself.” Aristotle’s answer (provisional): “It seems that of most πάθη (*pathē*), the soul does not undergo or do anything without the body—for example, getting-angry, having-courage, desiring, perceiving in general.”

Heidegger’s gloss: the term ἄνθρωπος (*anthrōpos*, “human being”) is what κοινόν (*koinon*, “common”) means here. The body—corporeality, σῶμα (*sōma*)—“somehow takes part in all having-courage, in all perceiving.”

Αἰσθάνεσθαι (*aisthanesthai*) Recast

Aristotle’s αἰσθάνεσθαι (*aisthanesthai*, “to perceive”) is mistranslated, Heidegger argues, when rendered “perception” in the narrow epistemological sense. It is “awareness in the sense of having-there of the world” (p. 133)—a *having-itself-toward* the world that is constitutive of being-in-the-world. Even νοεῖν (*noein*, “thinking”) “seems to be peculiar to the soul” only on a superficial reading; in fact, even νοεῖν (*noein*) requires φαντασία (*phantasia*, “making-present,” “imagination”). And “if even νοεῖν (*noein*), the thorough deliberating of a matter when I do not have it perceptually present, is something like a φαντασία (*phantasia*) or cannot be without φαντασία (*phantasia*), then thinking too cannot be without participation in the context of the entire life of a human being” (p. 134).

Φαντασία (*phantasia*) as Bodily Making-Present

“Thinking: this is not an appeal to a brain process, but to φαντασία (*phantasia*), the ‘making-present-to-itself’ of the world, in which what is made present is not actually there, but instead is, say, in memory or in a merely faint making-present. Even in thinking about something, the matters are there in the making-present. Φαντασία (*phantasia*) is the ground for νοεῖν (*noein*). Insofar as νόησις (*noēsis*, ‘thinking’) is the highest possibility for the being of human beings, the entire being of human beings is determined so that it must be apprehended as the *bodily being-in-the-world* of human beings.” (p. 134)

This is the section’s high-water-mark thesis: *bodily being-in-the-world is the determination of the entire human being*, including its highest cognitive activity. Φαντασία (*phantasia*) is the *bodily ground* that makes νοεῖν (*noein*) possible.

The Programmatic Indictment of the Tradition

“What was, here, provided by Aristotle, is still not taken advantage of today. Only in *phenomenology* has this begun. No division between ‘psychic’ and ‘bodily acts’! ... One must note that *the primary being-there-function of bodiliness secures the ground for the full being of human beings*. The beginnings of the entire tradition’s erroneous orientation toward the biological (*Descartes’s res cogitans — res extensa*) is also found in Aristotle.” (p. 134)

Heidegger explicitly frames the entire Cartesian metaphysics as a *misreading* of Aristotelian roots—phenomenology recovers what Cartesianism distorted.

Recapitulation of the Four Senses (p. 134)

Heidegger summarizes:

- ^c(1) changeable constitution [the broadest sense];
- ^c(2) special meaning [actualization of alteration];
- ^c(3) that which tones life down [the unpleasant];
- ^c(4) πάθος (*pathos*) especially as harmful [adversity, “a blow”].

He then poses the central ontological question: to what extent are phenomena like fear, anger, etc., set forth as general determinations of πάθος (*pathos*); and in what sense are the πάθη (*pathē*) to be considered as γινόμενα τῆς ψυχῆς (*ginomena tēs psychēs*, “occurrences of the soul”)?

The Definition of Ψυχή (*psychē*) as οὐσία (*ousia*)

“Ψυχή (*psychē*) means all that constitutes the being of a living thing, as that which constitutes being.” (p. 134)

Soul is *the being-determination* of the living thing—not an entity, not an inner room, but the οὐσία (*ousia*, “being”) of the living. The manifoldness of being-contexts is therefore subordinated to a “determinate manifoldness of determinate object-categories”—the categorial articulation of what it is to be a living being.

Νοῦς (*nous*, “intellect”): The Limit Question

Heidegger now takes the discussion to its limit case—the question of νοῦς (*nous*, “intellect”) in *De Anima* Γ 4–5:

(*nous*) Likened to (phōs, “light”)

“Aristotle likens νοῦς (*nous*) to φῶς (*phōs*). Just as it is through light that a color first comes to its being-there, is in there [present] insofar as it stands in illumination—being-there as the characteristic illumination—so *every being that is there as a being requires a fundamental illumination in order to be there.*” (p. 135)

The metaphysical weight: νοῦς (*nous*) is the basic condition of the possibility of being-in-the-world (p. 135). It is the *medium of disclosedness*. Heidegger’s German rendering of being-in-the-world as *Erschlossenheit* (“disclosedness”) begins to crystallize here.

Three Determinations of (nous)

1. δυνατόν (*dynaton*, “possibility”): νοῦς (*nous*) is “the possibility of simply being-opened-up, of the there of something.” Every concrete grasping operates and maintains itself within νοῦς (*nous*).
2. ἀπαθές (*apathes*, “that which nothing can touch”): νοῦς (*nous*), as condition of possibility, cannot itself be a πάθος (*pathos*) in the ordinary sense. It is “that which nothing can touch.”
3. δεκτικὸν τοῦ εἶδους (*dektikon tou eidous*, “being-able-to-take-up the εἶδος”): νοῦς (*nous*) is *able to receive the look of a being at the moment* (*De an.* Γ 4, 429a 15).

Excursus: Is (nous) Really Untouched? The (A)/(B) Distinction and the Phantasia Question

The three determinations above generate a tension that Heidegger himself half-acknowledges and never fully closes. The tension is this: if νοῦς (*nous*) is ἀπαθές (*apathes*, “that which nothing can touch”), how can it also be the case — as Aristotle insists at *De an.* Γ 7, 431a 16 and Γ 8, 432a 8, and as Heidegger reaffirms at p. 134 — that φαντασία (*phantasia*) is the ground for νοεῖν (*noein*)? If νοῦς ontologically depends on φαντασία, and φαντασία is the bodily making-present of the world, then νοῦς would seem to be touched by the world through and through.

The resolution Heidegger is implicitly using — following Aristotle’s own internal distinction in *De an.* Γ 5 — turns on keeping two νοῦς-claims apart:

The Distinction Aristotle is Using (and Heidegger Inherits)

- ^c(A) νοῦς as the *structural-ontological* condition of being-encounterable. This is νοῦς as δύναμις/ἀπαθές/δεκτικόν — what Aristotle in *De an.* Γ 5, 430a 14 calls the νοῦς “that makes all things” (ποιητικός), the condition for there being a clearing at all. *This* νοῦς is ἀπαθές (*apathes*) because it is the *medium of affectability*, not an item within it.
- ^c(B) νοῦς as the *concrete cognitive exercise* of a particular human being — what Aristotle calls the νοῦς “that becomes all things” (παθητικός, *De an.* Γ 5, 430a 24), the νοῦς that *does* require φαντάσματα (*phantasmata*, “images”), that *is* embodied, that *is* gripped by what shows up.

The phantasia-claim — entirely correct as Aristotle-exegesis — applies precisely to (B). Heidegger affirms it without reservation: “the *noein* of human beings is *not pure*; it is grounded in phantasia” (p. 136). Human νοεῖν (*noein*) *is* touched, it *is* μετὰ σώματος (*meta sōmatos*), it *is* embodied through and through.

The ἀπαθές-claim is reserved for (A). Just as light is what lets colors be seen but is not itself colored, νοῦς in this structural sense is what lets beings be encountered but is not itself one of the encounterable beings. It is “untouchable” *not because it is insulated from the world but because it is the clearing in which touching happens*. To call the clearing “touched” would be a category mistake — not because it sits above the fray but because *it is not the kind of thing to which affection-and-non-affection apply*.

Concrete Real-World Example: Reading This Sentence

Consider what happens as you read this sentence. The words on the page *strike* your eye; the visual impressions are organized through φαντασία (*phantasia*) into making-present the meanings; the meanings are taken-as-meanings and tracked through their argumentative connections. All of this is happening in your concrete embodied νοεῖν (*noein*) — the (B)-νοῦς, which is fully bodily, fully temporal, fully μετὰ σώματος.

But ask: *what makes it possible that the marks on the page can be encountered as words at all?* Not your retina, which only handles photons. Not your brain's pattern-recognition, which is itself an embodied process. The condition of possibility for there being any “encountering of words as words” is the *standing intelligibility-character* of any encounter whatsoever — the (A)-*νοῦς*. That condition is not itself something that gets struck by photons or processed by neurons. It is the *clearing within which* photon-striking and neuron-processing become an event of meaning at all. To ask whether *this* condition is “touched” is to make a category mistake — like asking whether the visibility-of-the-visible is itself visible.

So the answer to your question “is *νοῦς* touched?” depends on which *νοῦς* one is asking about:

- ^c *Concrete human* (the embodied act of reading): yes, deeply, ineradicably — through φαντασία, through σῶμα, through being-in-the-world. This is exactly what §18c argues at p. 134 (“the entire being of human beings is determined so that it must be apprehended as the *bodily being-in-the-world*”).
- ^c *as the structural condition-of-encounter* (the ἀπαθείς claim): no — but only because affection is the wrong category for it. The clearing is not “above” affection; affection is what *happens within* it.

The Genuine Residual Problem

This (A)/(B) distinction *almost* dissolves the tension. Where it does not is at the precise point where Heidegger reads the (A)-*νοῦς* partly through Aristotle's *active intellect* doctrine (*De an.* Γ 5, 430a 17–18: χωριστὸς καὶ ἀπαθὴς καὶ ἀμιγής, “separable, impassive, unmixed”; 430a 22–23: ἀθάνατον καὶ αἰδίδιον, “immortal and eternal”). Heidegger himself flags at p. 135–136 that this is precisely the place where Aristotle “did not pursue this doctrine to the extent that he in fact saw the matter. He allowed the investigation of *νοῦς* to stand because he went no further with respect to the matter.”

What Heidegger does *not* do in 1924 is reconcile his own commitment to the bodily-being-in-the-world thesis (the entire thrust of §18c) with the (A)-*νοῦς* claim that something in *νοῦς* *escapes* corporeality. Three live possibilities remain adjudicated:

1. (i) The (A)-*νοῦς* is genuinely something *more than* human concrete being — Aristotle's “from outside” (θύραθεν, *thyrathen*; GA B 3, 736b 27) — and the (B)-*νοῦς* is its bodily inflection in finite human beings. (The orthodox medieval reading.)
2. (ii) The (A)-*νοῦς* is just the *structural feature* of (B)-*νοῦς* viewed transcendently: there is no *νοῦς* apart from human νοεῖν; the ἀπαθείς is a description of the clearing-character intrinsic to embodied disclosure. (The proto-Heideggerian reading; closer to *Being and Time*.)
3. (iii) Aristotle is genuinely undecided — *De an.* Γ 5 is sketching a problem he does not solve.

The Ontological Payoff

What this excursus secures: the ἀπαθείς-claim is preserved at the *transcendental-structural* level (the disclosedness-character of disclosure is not itself a disclosed item) but is rejected at the *ontic-dualist* level (there is no separable faculty of *νοῦς* insulated from bodily being-in-the-world). The 1924 lectures are *transitional* on this question: Heidegger is still reading Aristotle in a way that lets (A)-*νοῦς* have its untouchable structure, but the trajectory of his own thinking is pushing toward option (ii). By 1927, in *Being and Time* §28 (H. 132–133), this trajectory is completed: “*Da-sein* is its disclosedness... it is itself the clearing [es selbst die Lich-

tung ist].” There is no clearing apart from the bodily-finite-thrown disclosedness of Da-sein. The 1924 ἀπαθείς gets reabsorbed into the structural feature of finite existence rather than remaining a separable transcendent.

The cleanest single-sentence rejoinder to anyone who presses the phantasia-objection: Heidegger means that νοῦς is ἀπαθείς as the clearing-character of encounter, not as a separable faculty insulated from the world; the insight that human νοεῖν is bodily is correct, and Heidegger is in the process of working out — and will fully work out, in BT — that the clearing-character of disclosure has no existence apart from the embodied, finite Da-sein in which it is realized.

(*nous*) Goes Toward

(*ta panta*, “all things”)

“Νοῦς (*nous*), in relation to the being-opened-up of being-in, is more than the human being can be since the way that the human being takes up this possibility, νοῦς (*nous*), is διανοεῖσθαι (*dianoesthai*, ‘to think-through’). Insofar as νοῦς (*nous*) constitutes the being-opened-up of the human being, it is διὰ (*dia*, ‘through-by-means-of’), insofar as living is determined by λύπη (*lypē*, ‘pain’) and ἡδονή (*hēdonē*, ‘pleasure’). Νοῦς (*nous*) is the basic condition of the possibility of being-in-the-world, and as such stands beyond the particular concrete being of individual human beings.” (p. 135)

The Open Question:
outside”)?

(*idion pathos*) or

(*thyrathen*, “from

Aristotle’s question, which Heidegger highlights at p. 136: is νοῦς (*nous*) an ἰδίον πάθος τῆς ψυχῆς (*idion pathos tēs psychēs*, “a proper πάθος of the soul”), or does it enter from outside (θύραθεν, *thyrathen*)? The aporia: does νοῦς (*nous*) constitute the being of human beings *as proper to such a being*, or *enter into* human beings from outside?

Heidegger reads Aristotle’s evidence as showing: a living thing, insofar as it is encountered by the world, *is also encountered with a view to its corporeality*—“everything aims at the living thing in its full being-there” (p. 136). Even νοῦς (*nous*) is therefore *not pure* in the human case: “the supposing of something that I do not actually have there is grounded in φαντασία (*phantasia*); it is only possible on the basis of making-present, and making-present is, as such, nothing other than the retrieval of that which was at one time present” (p. 136). Φαντασία (*phantasia*) is “a special making-present”—a making-present in which the knowing of the having-once-been-experienced of that which is retrieved.

The verdict: even at the limit case of νοῦς (*nous*), the πάθος (*pathos*)-structure (πάσχειν τοῦ σώματος, *paschein tou sōmatos*, “the undergoing of the body”) asserts itself.

[Phase 2 commentary flags this as a genuine textual tension: νοῦς (*nous*) is characterized as ἀπαθείς (*apathēs*, “untouchable”), yet the entire argument of §18c is that all πάθη (*pathē*) are μετὰ σώματος (*meta sōmatos*, “with the body”). Whether Heidegger fully reconciles this, or whether he leaves Aristotle’s *De Anima* Γ 5 doctrine of the active intellect as a residual problem, is debated. Heidegger himself admits Aristotle “did not pursue this doctrine to the extent that he in fact saw the matter. He allowed the investigation of νοῦς to stand because he went no further with respect to the matter” (p. 135).]

§18d. The Double-Type of Consideration of πάθος (*pathos*) according to εἶδος (*eidos*) and ὕλη (*hylē*), and the Question Concerning the Task of the φυσικός (*phusikos*)

(*De Anima* I, 403a 24 sqq.) · pp. 137–139

This subsection draws the methodological conclusions: if πάθος (*pathos*) is bodily being-in-the-world, then the *investigation* of πάθος (*pathos*) is itself doubly determined—it must address both the εἶδος (*eidos*, “look,” “form”) and the ὕλη (*hylē*, “matter”) of the phenomenon. This grounds Aristotle’s distinction among the φυσικός (*phusikos*, “natural philosopher”), the διαλεκτικός (*dialektikos*, “dialectician”) / rhetorician, and the φιλόσοφος (*philosophos*, “philosopher proper”).

The Definitional Move

“The addressing of this phenomenon, which should hit upon the πάθη (*pathē*) as to what they are, must proceed toward that on the basis of which the πάθη (*pathē*) are, that wherein they are found. Their ὕλη (*hylē*) is nothing other than σῶμα (*sōma*), the corporeality of the human being.” (p. 137)

A crucial conceptual move: ὕλη (*hylē*) here = σῶμα (*sōma*). [Phase 2 commentary marks this as a possible tension with §17a, where Heidegger insisted that ὕλη (*hylē*) “does not mean an indeterminate ‘material’ but rather a positive character of a mode of being-there”—being-in-preparedness (δεκτικόν, *dektikon*). The two senses can be reconciled only by reading the σῶμα (*sōma*) of §18d *through* the δεκτικόν (*dektikon*) of §17a—i.e., the body is itself *being-in-preparedness for* πάθος (*pathos*). The Phase 2 analyst rates this reconciliation as INTERP-low (likely Heidegger’s intent).]

The ὅροι (*horoi*) of ὀργή (*orgē*, “anger”)

Heidegger then takes up Aristotle’s example of *De Anima* A 1, 403a 25 sqq. The ὅροι (*horoi*, “definitional boundaries”) of ὀργή (*orgē*) must be of a specific kind:

“Being-angry is something like a being-in-motion of the body constituted thus and so” (*De an.* A 1, 403a 26)

—a fully determinate motion from definite circumstances. At one and the same time:

ἡ ὕλη (*hē hylē*, “the matter”) is seen—ἐν τοιῷδὲ σώματι (*en toiōdi sōmati*, “in such-and-such a body”)—and τὸ εἶδος (*to eidos*, “the form”) is addressed—in the being-so of being-of-concern: ὑπὸ τοῦδε ἕνεκα τοῦδε (*hypo toude heneka toude*, “by this for the sake of this”) (*De an.* A 1, 403a 27).

With that, λόγος (*logos*) is simultaneously addressed—speech, the articulating “by-this-for-the-sake-of-this.” This yields a *fundamental epistemological definition*:

“Therefore, it is already a matter of the φυσικός (*phusikos*) to take into view that which lies within the thematic circle of the being of living things.” (p. 137)

Φυσικός (*phusikos*), Διαλεκτικός (*dialektikos*), Τεχνίτης (*technitēs*), Μαθηματικός (*mathēmatikos*), Φιλόσοφος (*philosophos*)

Heidegger then deploys Aristotle’s stratification of disciplines (cf. *De Anima* A 1, 403a 29 sqq.):

The Two Definitions of (orgē, “anger”):

1. The διαλεκτικός (*dialektikos*) / rhetorician defines anger as ὀρέξις ἀντιλυπήσεως (*orexis antilypēseōs*)—“an aiming-after pay-back,” a “being-toward-others” in the mode of comporting-oneself toward other human beings. This grasps the εἶδος (*eidos*).
2. The φυσικός (*phusikos*) defines anger as ζέσις τοῦ περὶ καρδίαν αἵματος καὶ θερμοῦ—“a boiling up of blood in the heart and of the temperature” (*De an.* A 1, 403a 31). This grasps the ὕλη (*hylē*) as σῶμα (*sōma*).

The first λόγος (*logos*) yields the *genuine* εἶδος (*eidos*)—the comporting-toward-other-human-beings—but as a determination of the being of human beings *in the world*, it is necessarily co-determined by the ζέσις (*zesis*, “boiling-up”) of the blood. Both λόγοι (*logoi*) are λόγοι ἐνυλοὶ (*logoi enyloi*, “enmattered λόγοι”), but in entirely different senses (p. 139).

“If that is so, then it is clear that the πάθη (*pathē*) are λόγοι ἐνυλοὶ (*logoi enyloi*).” (*De an.* A 1, 403a 24, quoted at p. 137)

This is the formula Heidegger underlines. Πάθη (*pathē*) are *enmattered* (*logoi*): their meaning-articulation (*Logos-Charakter*) is inseparable from their bodily occurrence. To strip a πάθος (*pathos*) of its corporeality is to lose the phenomenon itself.

The Hierarchy of Disciplines

Heidegger constructs a hierarchy by way of the example of a house (λόγος οἰκίας, *logos oikias*, “definition of a house”; *De an.* A 1, 403b 3):

Inquirer	Mode of Definition
One inquirer	Speaks of the εἶδος (<i>eidos</i>)—“shelter, protection that keeps away the possibility of being harmed by wind, rain, heat”—the σκέπασμα (<i>skepasma</i> , “covering”).
Another	Speaks of the ὕλη (<i>hylē</i>)—stones, brick, wood.
The genuine φυσικός (<i>phusikos</i>)	Speaks ἐξ ἀμφοῖν (<i>ex amphoin</i> , “from both”)—addresses the house “in terms of the look that in itself is related to what the house consists of.”

“He who only speaks about the material has no knowledge of the matter in question is genuinely selected. Or is it he who only speaks about the εἶδος (*eidos*): Or is it he who speaks ἐξ ἀμφοῖν (*ex amphoin*):” (p. 138, quoting *De an.* A 1, 403b 6 sqq.)

The decisive move:

“The being of nature is determined in its look not simply by ὕλη (*hylē*) but primarily by being-moved.” (p. 138)

Φύσις (*physis*, “nature”) is grasped through *being-moved*—κίνησις (*kinēsis*)—and only beings determined by being-moved are the genuine and definite topic of the φυσικός (*phusikos*).

^cThe φυσικός (*phusikos*) takes σώματα (*sōmata*, “bodies”) *as constituted* thus and so—i.e., as ἐργα καὶ πάθη (*erga kai pathē*, “works and πάθη”)—πάθη (*pathē*) in the very broad sense of *Metaphysics* Δ 21 (sense 1).

- °The τεχνίτης (*technitēs*, “craftsman”) considers wood, e.g., insofar as it possesses hardness apt to serve as a rudder—i.e., considers σῶμα (*sōma*) *under a* *-perspective*.
- °The doctor considers σώματα (*sōmata*) differently—in accordance with τέχνη (*technē*) but oriented to therapy.
- °The μαθηματικός (*mathēmatikos*, “mathematician”) takes σώματα (*sōmata*) “not as constituted thus and so, not as tree-trunk, as the stable part of a plant, not as material; but solely insofar as it is extended” (p. 138). This abstraction will become Heidegger’s key example for what πάθος (*pathos*) is *not*.

The

(*prōtos philosophos*, “first philosopher”)

“Beyond these ways of considering, there is yet another way, which takes every being with a view to its being-determinations; not with a view to, say, being-extended alone, but taking all possible beings together in the fundamental question concerning being as such. This is the object of the πρῶτος φιλόσοφος (*prōtos philosophos*).” (p. 138)

This is Aristotle’s own definition of πρώτη φιλοσοφία (*prōtē philosophia*, “first philosophy”)—i.e., metaphysics—as the science of being qua being.

The “Mathematical” Counter-Example

Heidegger uses the mathematical-objectivity case to consolidate his doctrine of bodily inseparability:

“There is nothing like a pure fear in the sense of an abstract comporting-oneself toward something. In itself, it is a comporting of the full human being in its corporeality. But this inability-to-be-abstracted is different from that of mathematical objectivities. The πάθη cannot be identified with the lines and surfaces of bodies in the mathematical sense. The Greek does not see a line primarily in itself, but instead γραμμή (*grammē*, ‘line’) is always the limit of a surface, and surface the limit of a body. The surface has no being without the body—thus, here too, an inability-to-become-separated. In this way, the εἶδος (*eidōs*) of fearing also has the primary relatedness to a finding-oneself of the body. The difference lies in the fact that the determinate constitution of σώματα (*sōmata*) plays no role in mathematical inseparability, for instance in the being-brown or being-scratched of the body; the thus and so constituted way of being is essential. Both are λόγοι ἐνυλοὶ (*logoi enyloi*), but in an entirely different sense.” (p. 139)

The key result: πάθη (*pathē*) and mathematical objects are *both* enmattered, but only πάθη (*pathē*) require the *determinate* constitution of the body as essential. The geometer’s body-as-extended could be any body; the angry person’s body must be *this* body, in *this* condition (boiling blood, heat in the heart).

Conclusion of §18 — and the Bridge to the *Rhetoric*

“This is the ground for the type of consideration of the πάθη (*pathē*), with a view to the εἶδος (*eidōs*), which is found in the *Rhetoric*. It is important that Aristotle does not obtain a basic determination of a living thing from physiological considerations. The εἶδος (*eidōs*) of the πάθη (*pathē*) is a comporting-oneself to other human beings, a being-in-the-world. Only from this standpoint can the ὕλη (*hylē*) of the πάθη (*pathē*) be genuinely examined.” (p. 139)

This sentence vindicates the *Rhetoric* (which §15–16 set up) as the proper scientific treatment of πάθη (*pathē*) qua εἶδος (*eidos*)—i.e., as comportments-toward-others. Aristotle’s *Rhetoric* B 1–11 (the catalog of πάθη: ὀργή [*orgē*], φόβος [*phobos*], ἔλεος [*eleos*], etc.) is precisely this εἶδος-treatment, and Heidegger has now justified its priority over physiology.

The Coda on νοῦς (*nous*) and τὰ πάντα (*ta panta*)

Heidegger ends §18 with a brief return to *De Anima* A 1’s νοῦς (*nous*)-question:

“Νοῦς (*nous*), ‘supposing,’ in contrast with all other ways of grasping, is a possibility of grasping that is not limited to a determinate region of being, as is hearing, seeing, and so on. Instead, νοῦς (*nous*) goes toward τὰ πάντα (*ta panta*, ‘all things’); it is a possibility of grasping that grasps all possible beings, so that the being in question need not necessarily be present. This universality of the possibility of grasping is something that is not to be equated with the concrete being of the human being, which is always at the moment. What grounds this possibility of grasping everything, which grows out beyond the human being and its concrete being? In connection with this question, Aristotle discusses the πάθη (*pathē*) as those phenomena in which it is shown that the concrete being of human beings can only be understood if one takes it in its fullness, and so on the basis of various considerations. It is, above all, decisive that we lose composure in the case [...]” (p. 139, end of §18)

§18 thus closes by re-binding the νοῦς-question to the πάθος-question: the πάθη (*pathē*) are the phenomena that *force* us to take the human in its *fullness*—precisely because they show that “we lose composure” (*verlieren die Fassung*), i.e., that the ἐξίς/πάθος dialectic is the very texture of human being-in-the-world.

Synthetic Reading of §18

Architectural Position

§18 stands at the structural center of GA 18. Chapter 3 of the First Part has progressed: §13–14 (speaking-being, rhetoric, πίστις [*pistis*, “credence”]); §15–16 (δόξα [*doxa*, “opinion”], ἦθος [*ēthos*, “character”] / πάθος [*pathos*] as πίστεις [*pisteis*]); §17 (ἐξίς [*hexis*] as fundamental concept of being); §18 now consolidates the whole by giving πάθος (*pathos*) its full ontological articulation. From here, §19–22 deploy specific πάθη (φύσις [*physis*], ἡδονή/λύπη [*hēdonē/lypē*, “pleasure/pain”], φόβος [*phobos*, “fear”]).

Five Theses Heidegger Establishes

1. Πάθος (*pathos*) is a fundamental concept of being, not an ethical or psychological category. (§18a)
2. Πάθη (*pathē*) are bodily being-in-the-world—the disposition of the entire human being in the world, not “spiritual states” with “bodily symptoms.” (§18a, §18c)
3. The four general meanings (*Met.* Δ21) form a progressive narrowing from alterability-as-such to the harmful-as-blow, all converging on πάθος (*pathos*) as the ontological structure of *occurring-to-the-living-being*. (§18b)
4. The πάθη are λόγοι ἐνυλοι (*logoi enyloi*, “enmattered λόγοι”)—their λόγος (*logos*) is inseparable from their σῶμα (*sōma*). (§18d)

5. The double consideration (εἶδος / ὕλη) defines a hierarchy of inquiry: the διαλεκτικός (*dialektikos*) / rhetorician handles the εἶδος (Aristotle's *Rhetoric*), the φυσικός (*phusikos*) handles the ὕλη as κινούμενον σῶμα (*kinoumenon sōma*, “moved body”), and only the πρῶτος φιλόσοφος (*prōtos philosophos*) addresses being as such. (§18d)

Connections to *Being and Time* (1927)

§18 is the philological-systematic source for several signature doctrines of *Being and Time*:

- Πάθος, Befindlichkeit / Stimmung (BT §29): the threefold structure of every πάθος (πῶς διακείμενοι [*pōs diakeimenoι*, “how they are disposed”], ποίαις [*poiais*, “in what manner”], ἐπὶ ποίοις [*epi poiois*, “with respect to what”]) (*Rhet.* B 1, 1378a 24, cited in §16) prefigures the threefold of attunement: how one finds oneself, what one is attuned to, in respect to whom.
- Φόβος, Furcht / Angst (BT §30, §40): the §18a remark on “fear in the face of the nothing” is the proto-formulation of the *Angst*-analytic.
- Bodily being-in-the-world, In-der-Welt-sein (BT §12 ff.): “the primary being-there-function of bodiliness secures the ground for the full being of human beings” (p. 134) is the 1924 articulation of what BT will call the worldhood of the world.
- Νοῦς / φῶς, Erschlossenheit (BT §28): νοῦς (*nous*) as the “fundamental illumination” required for any being to be there is the ancestor of the “clearing” (*Lichtung*) doctrine.

Three Tensions Worth Flagging

1. The dual sense of ὕλη (*hylē*): in §17a it is *positive being-in-preparedness* (δεκτικόν, *dektikon*); in §18d it is σῶμα (*sōma*) as material substrate. Reconcilable, but Heidegger does not explicitly thematize the reconciliation.
2. Νοῦς (*nous*) as ἀπαθείς (*apathēs*): the limit-claim that νοῦς (*nous*) is “untouchable” stands in tension with the universal claim that all πάθη (*pathē*) are μετὰ σώματος (*meta sōmatos*). Aristotle's deferral to *De Anima* Γ 4–5 is left unsealed.
3. The Hegelian σώζειν (*sōzein*), *Aufhebung* claim: Heidegger's parenthetical reading of Aristotle through Hegel (p. 132) is a strong interpretive gesture; whether σωτηρία (*sōtēria*) genuinely supports the triadic *Aufhebung* is not argued.

Source Inventory

Source	Path
Primary text (PDF pp. 144–154; book pp. 129–139)	corpus/rhetorical_ontology/Heidegger, Martin - Basic Concepts of Aristotelian Philosophy_(2009)_[Clean Copy].pdf
Phase 2 structured analysis	corpus/index/Heidegger - Basic Concepts of Aristotelian Philosophy/bcap-analysis/phase2-u-fp3c.md
Structured manifest (§17–§18)	corpus/index/Heidegger - Basic Concepts of Aristotelian Philosophy/bcap-structured/u-fp3c.json
New index (heidegger-bcap-4-5)	tmp/analysis-upgrade/.../claims.jsonl, concept-mentions.jsonl — <i>does not cover §18</i> (only PDF pp. 25–30)

Aristotelian primary texts cited in §18 (per Heidegger’s footnotes 232–271): *Met.* Δ21 1022b 15–21; *De an.* A 1, 403a 3, 403a 8, 403a 16, 403a 18–25, 403a 27–b 17, 403b 19; *De an.* Γ 4, 429a 15, 429a 22; *De an.* Γ 5, 430a 14; *NE* B 3, 1105b 4; *NE* B 5, 417b 2–14; *De an.* B 5, 417b 2–14; *De an.* A 4, 408b 11.